

HERITEDGE

From Generation to Generation



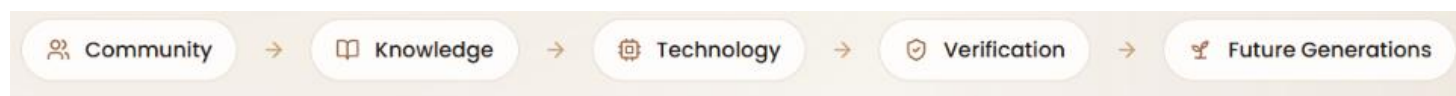
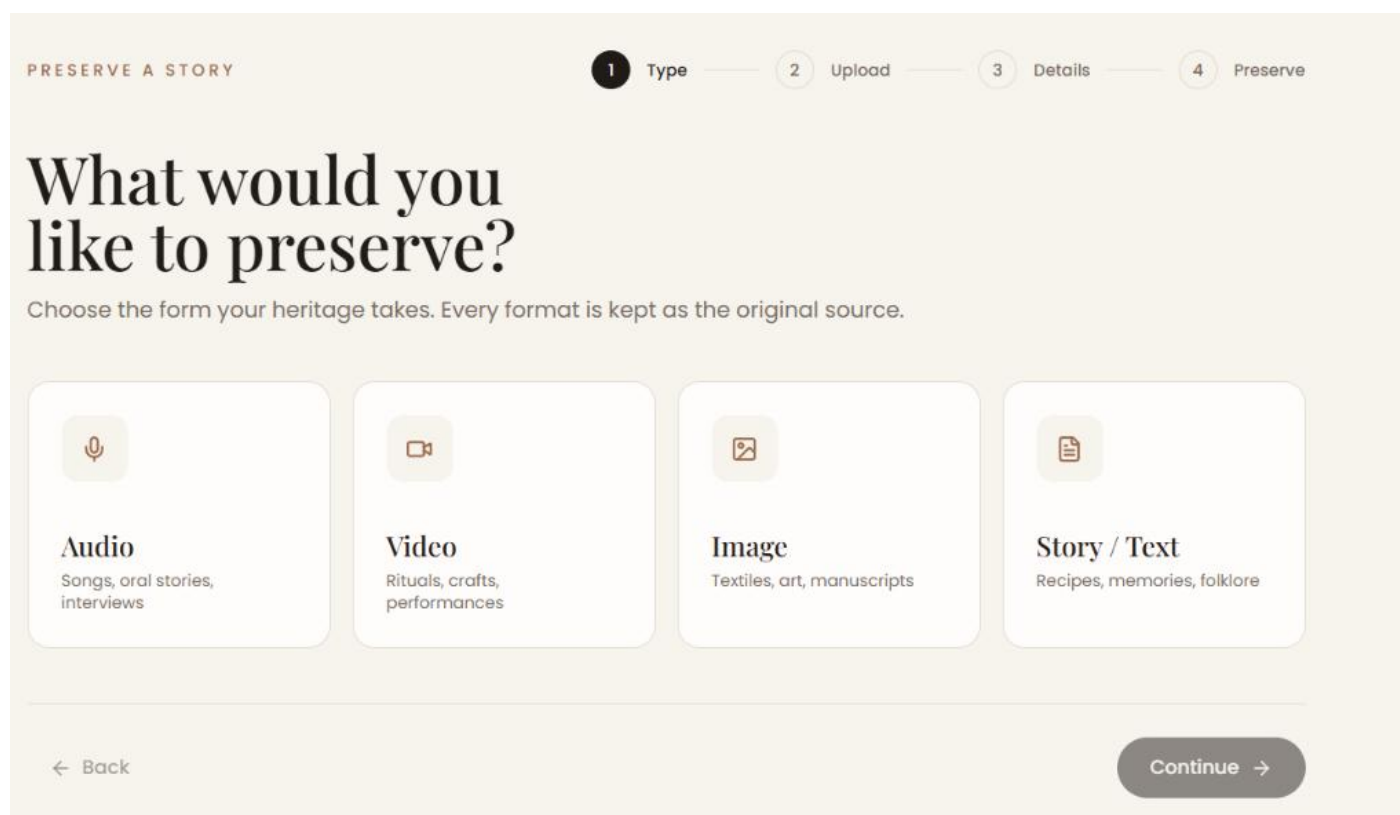
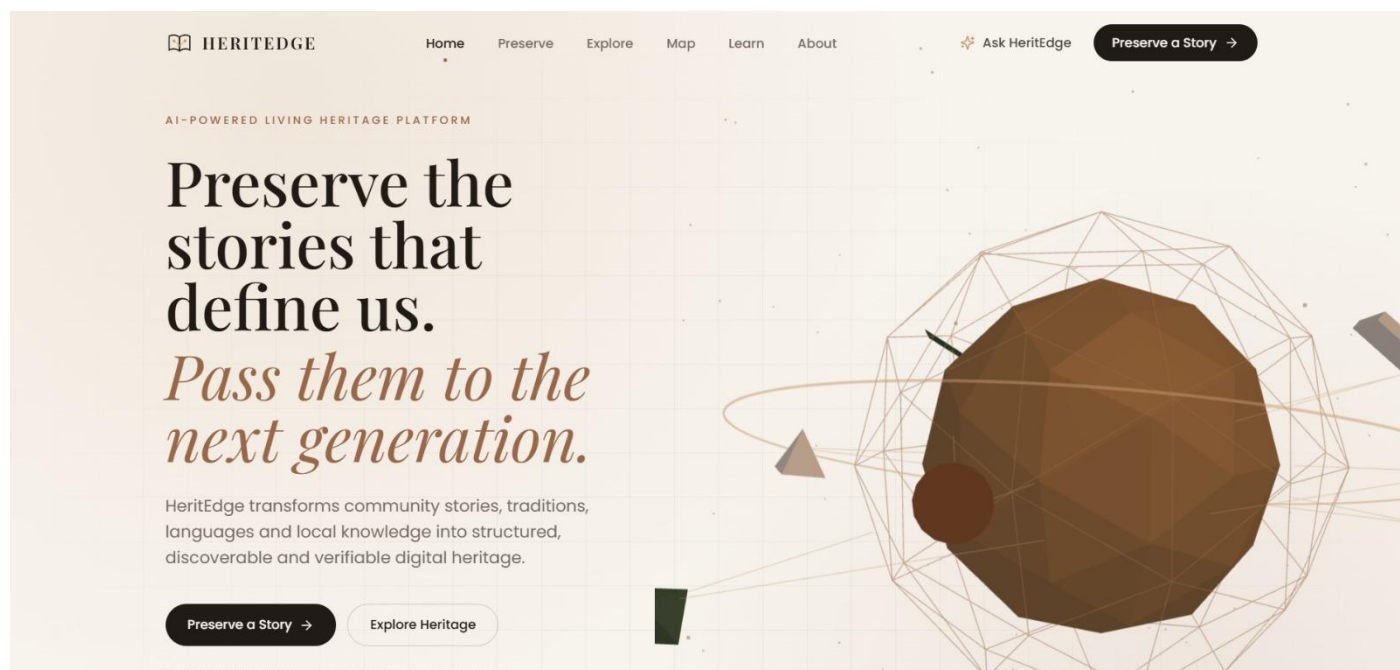
“Understanding the existing digital heritage ecosystem and identifying the gap
HeritEdge addresses”

Team HeritEdge

SIH 2026

Why HeritEdge?

India's cultural heritage is preserved across institutional archives, cultural portals, social platforms and community records. However, the process of capturing grassroots oral traditions and transforming them into structured, searchable and transferable cultural knowledge remains fragmented.



Existing Heritage Ecosystem

India's digital cultural landscape is rich and diverse, with multiple platforms preserving and promoting our heritage in different ways.

Many Platforms.
One Shared Goal —
Preserve Our Heritage.



✿ Different Platforms | Different Strengths | A Shared Vision ✿



EXISTING PLATFORMS — 01

Indian Culture Portal 2.0 & Sahapedia

INDIAN CULTURE PORTAL 2.0

WHAT EXISTS

- Digital cultural collections
- Museum, library & archive resources
- Multilingual access
- AI-powered cultural interaction

WHAT IT DOES WELL

DISCOVERY | DIGITAL COLLECTIONS | CULTURAL EDUCATION

HERITEDGE GAP

Primarily designed for discovering and exploring existing cultural resources. HeritEdge focuses on capturing new grassroots cultural knowledge and transforming it into structured heritage records.

Source: Indian Culture Portal

SAHAPEDIA

WHAT EXISTS

- Articles & cultural resources
- Oral histories & interviews
- Photos & videos
- Maps & timelines

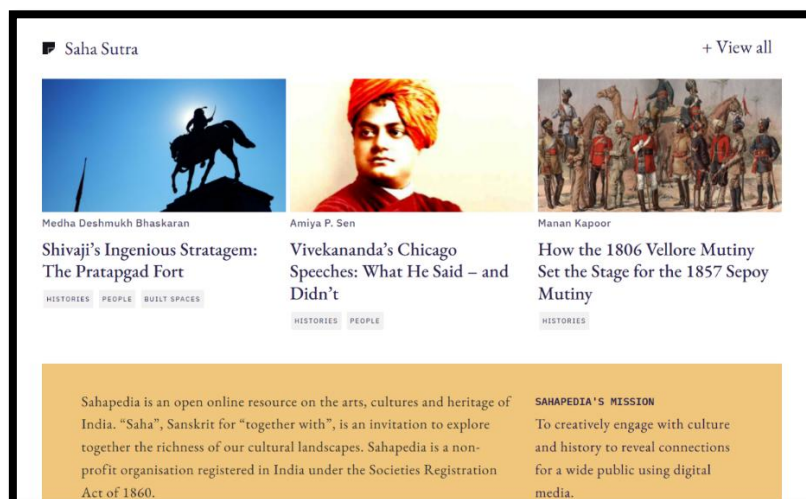
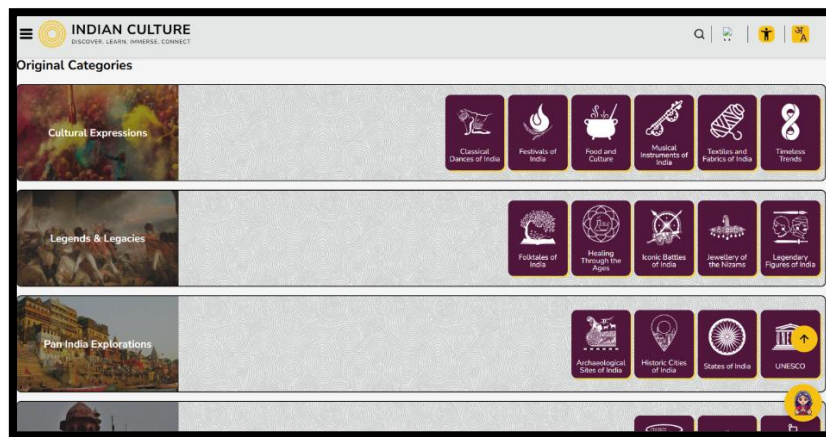
WHAT IT DOES WELL

DOCUMENTATION | MULTIMEDIA | COMMUNITY | EDUCATION

HERITEDGE GAP

Strong in curated cultural documentation and community knowledge. HeritEdge focuses on simplifying the capture of everyday living heritage through an AI-assisted workflow.

Source: Sahapedia



EXISTING PLATFORMS — 02

Digital District Repository & IGNCA

DIGITAL DISTRICT REPOSITORY

WHAT EXISTS

- District-level cultural information
- Local history and heritage resources
- Digital archives and documentation
- Regional cultural records

WHAT IT DOES WELL

LOCAL DISCOVERY | REGIONAL DOCUMENTATION
| DIGITAL ARCHIVING

HERITEDGE GAP

Provides valuable district-level information and documented cultural resources. HeritEdge focuses on enabling communities to actively contribute, structure and preserve new cultural knowledge rather than only accessing existing records.

Source: Digital District Repository

IGNCA

WHAT EXISTS

- Cultural archives and documentation
- Manuscripts, photographs & audio-visual resources
- Research on Indian arts and traditions
- Digital cultural collections

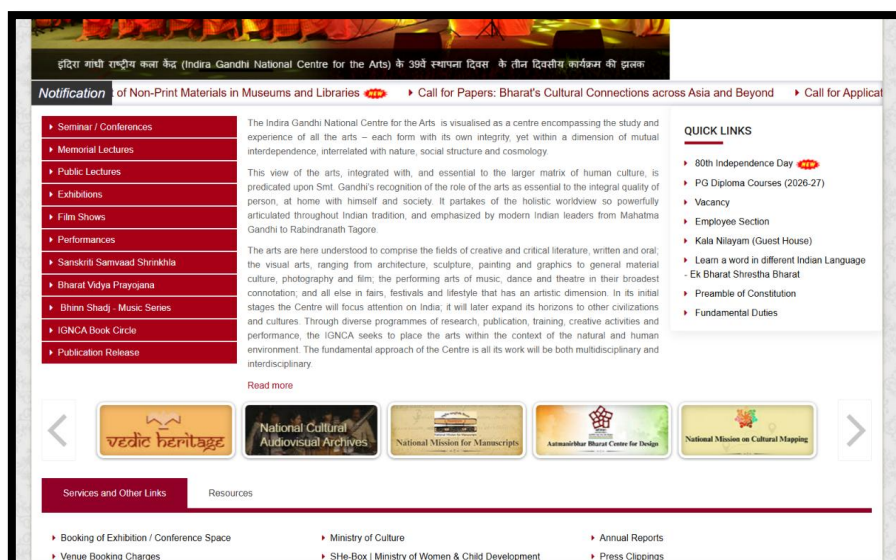
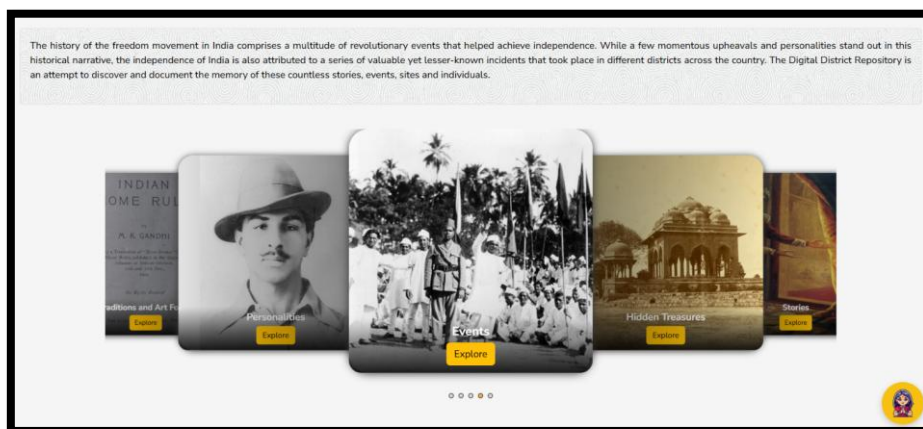
WHAT IT DOES WELL

RESEARCH | ARCHIVING | CULTURAL
DOCUMENTATION | PRESERVATION

HERITEDGE GAP

Strong in institutional research, archiving and preservation of India's cultural heritage. HeritEdge complements this approach by creating a simpler, AI-assisted pathway for communities to document living traditions at the grassroots level.

Source: Indira Gandhi National Centre for the Arts (IGNCA)



EXISTING PLATFORMS — 03

Google Arts & Culture & Dastkari Haat / Craft Maps

GOOGLE ARTS & CULTURE

WHAT EXISTS

- Digital exhibitions and cultural collections
- High-resolution artworks and artefacts
- Virtual tours and immersive experiences
- Stories from museums and cultural institutions

WHAT IT DOES WELL

DISCOVERY | VISUAL EXPERIENCE | DIGITAL EXHIBITIONS | GLOBAL ACCESS

HERITEDGE GAP

Excellent for discovering and experiencing digitised cultural collections from institutions worldwide. HeritEdge focuses on capturing cultural knowledge directly from communities before it becomes lost or undocumented.

Source: Google Arts & Culture

DASTKARI HAAT / CRAFT MAPS

WHAT EXISTS

- Traditional crafts and artisan profiles
- Craft traditions mapped across regions
- Information about Indian handicrafts
- Visibility for craftspeople and communities

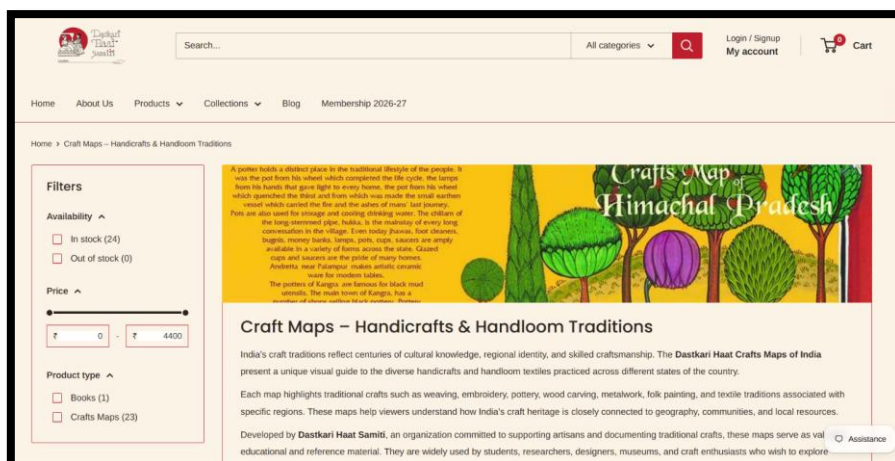
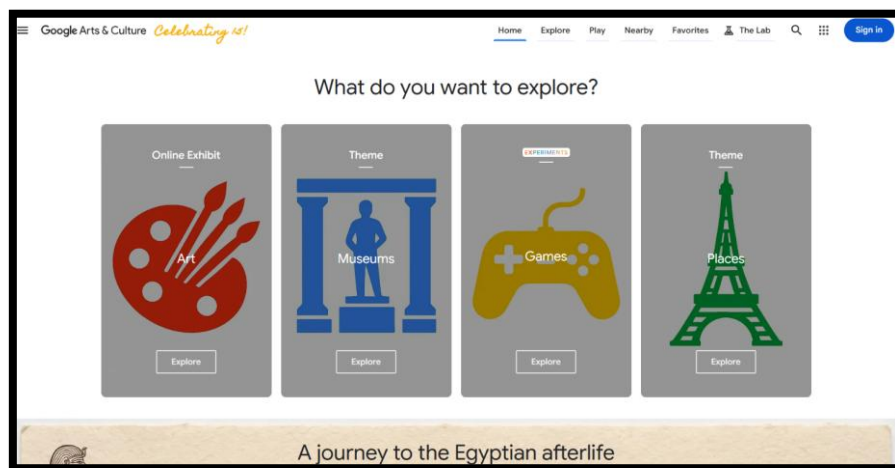
WHAT IT DOES WELL

CRAFT DISCOVERY | ARTISAN VISIBILITY | GEOGRAPHIC MAPPING | CULTURAL AWARENESS

HERITEDGE GAP

Strong in showcasing crafts, artisans and regional traditions. HeritEdge extends the idea of mapping heritage by enabling communities to continuously capture stories, practices, languages, recipes and other forms of living heritage.

Source: Dastkari Haat / Craft Maps



REFERENCE & RECOGNITION LAYER

UNESCO Intangible Cultural Heritage

UNESCO — WHAT IT DOES

RECOGNISES & DOCUMENTS

- Identifies significant intangible cultural heritage
- Maintains international heritage lists
- Promotes safeguarding of living traditions
- Raises global awareness of cultural practices

HERITEDGE — WHAT IT DOES

CAPTURES & PRESERVES

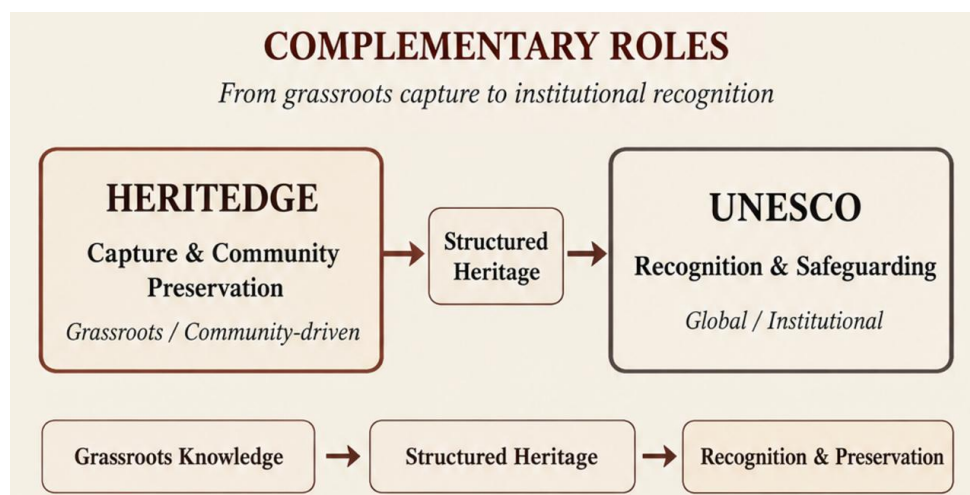
- Enables communities to record living traditions
- Converts audio, video, images and text into structured records
- Uses AI for transcription, translation and knowledge extraction
- Supports community validation and knowledge preservation

KEY DISTINCTION

UNESCO operates primarily as a global recognition and safeguarding framework. HeritEdge operates at the grassroots level, helping communities capture and structure living heritage before it is formally recognised or documented.

WHY THIS MATTERS

HeritEdge does not replace existing heritage institutions. It creates a community-driven layer that can help generate, organise and preserve cultural knowledge that may otherwise remain undocumented.



Reference: UNESCO Intangible Cultural Heritage

COMPETITIVE COMPARISON MATRIX

How HeritEdge differs from existing heritage platforms

Capability	ICP	Sahapedia	DDR	IGNCA	Google Arts	HeritEdge
Digital heritage resources	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Multimedia	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Community contribution	●	✓	✓	✓	●	✓
Oral-history capture	●	✓	✓	✓	×	✓
AI-assisted processing	✓	●	●	●	✓	✓
Regional-language processing	✓	✓	●	✓	✓	✓
Automatic cultural extraction	●	×	×	●	✓	✓
Structured heritage record generation	●	●	✓	✓	×	✓
Grassroots everyday heritage	●	✓	✓	●	×	✓
Capture → preserve → transmit pipeline	×	●	●	●	×	✓

Legend: ✓ Strong | ● Partial / Limited | × Not evident

COMPETITIVE TAKEAWAY

Existing platforms excel in discovery, documentation, archiving and cultural presentation. HeritEdge differentiates itself by combining grassroots capture, AI-assisted processing, structured heritage records, community validation and preservation into a single workflow.

HERITEDGE

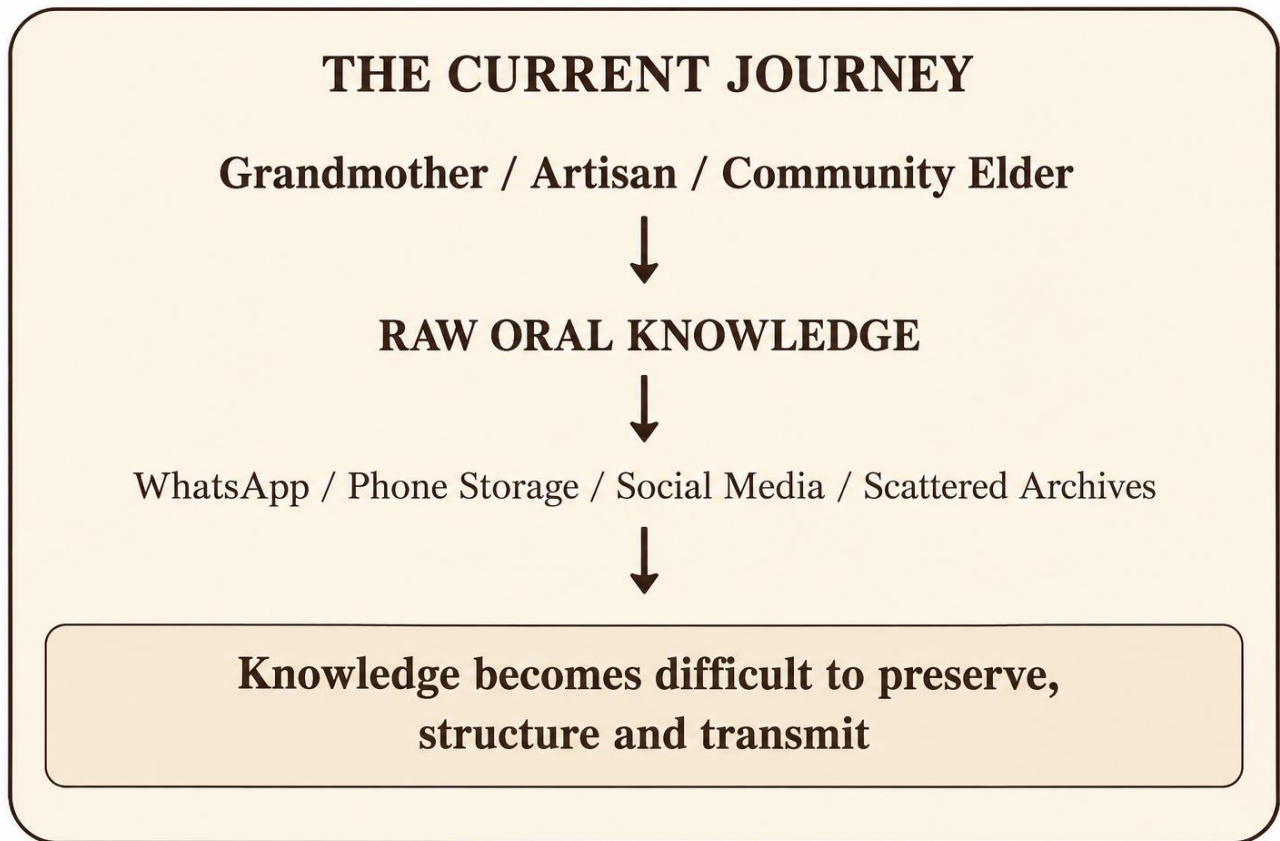
HERITEDGE WORKFLOW

CAPTURE → UNDERSTAND → STRUCTURE → VALIDATE → PRESERVE → TRANSMIT

THE GAP

The problem is not the absence of digital heritage platforms

The problem is that the heritage preservation journey is fragmented



HERITEDGE

FROM FRAGMENTED KNOWLEDGE TO STRUCTURED HERITAGE

HeritEdge Workflow

